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## 01 A Country That Never Recovers

Lebanon lives in one continuous crisis, not separate events, one wound. Wounds to the same body that never got a **chance to heal.**



NO emergency plans

1.5M displaced

80% poverty



LEBANON

## 02 Displacement Wounds Children



Silence. Witness.  
Rootless. Still  
here. Unseen.  
Unheard. Survival.  
The weight of  
knowing. Between  
wars. Left behind.

## 03 A Fragmented System

Improvisation. Political negotiation. Volunteer exhaustion. No national authority. No coordinated plan

04

## What I Built: What It Does

Two equal pillars

# FRONTLINERS

A CHILD-CENTERED EMERGENCY RESPONSE INITIATIVE

05

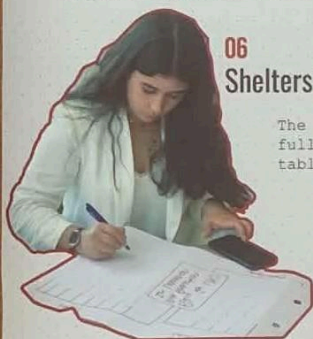
## SheReads in Practice

Bibliotherapy  
Storytelling  
Emotion cards  
Drawing  
Grounding

06

## Shelters To Policy Tables

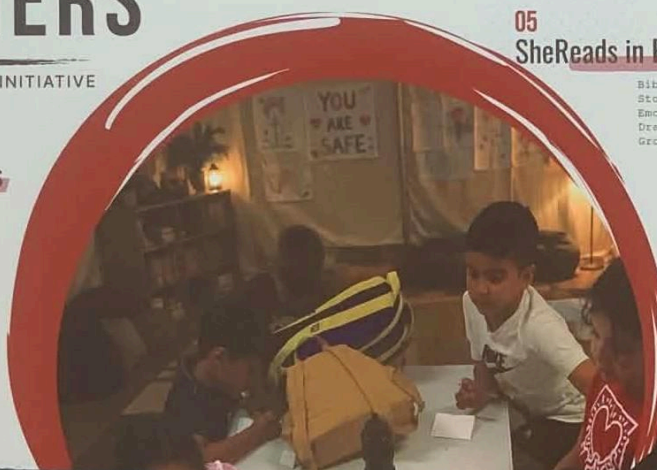
The shelter was full. The policy table was empty.



"The most radical act in Lebanon today is to demand that the state finally acts like one."

07

## Emergency Social Protection Mechanism



# Reflection Paper: Get Engaged Conference Gallery Walk

I walked around the Get Engaged Conference in the Exhibition Hall. Looked over several posters and spoke with various writers. There were various impressive presentations, among which the one that struck me was the poster titled **"FRONTLINERS: A Child-Centered Emergency Response Initiative"** presented by Ghina Sweidan, a student from the American University of Beirut. This project was one that immediately grabbed my attention.

While talking to Ghina, I asked her about how she came up with the idea for this project. She explained me that Lebanon is going through one continuous crisis and war where the wounds never get a chance to heal. According to her, the country faces a fragmented system with no emergency plans, 80% poverty, and over 1.5 million displaced people. As a psychology student, she couldn't keep her eyes closed and watch her country collapse. She didn't want to wait for others to take action to solve this tough problem facing the world, but wanted to prove herself to be an active participant.

To assess the needs of the community, Ghina looked closely at what regular relief efforts were completely missing. The main reasons for humanitarian aid are supplying food and basic tents, but children's psychological trauma is ignored. In her poster, she pointed out that "Displacement Wounds Children" and they are unheard and rootless witnesses of war. She understood how critical it was to provide mental health services in the community right now. For this, she created specific practices for children such as Bibliotherapy, Storytelling, Emotion Cards, Drawing and Grounding exercises to help understand their fears and provide a safe place amidst the chaos.

I asked her about the way she had organised the operationalisation of this project and she gave me a very practical, but difficult, journey. As a university student who had limited resources, she would go about her business using her academic network. She trained her colleagues in the fundamental psychological techniques used in the programme. They together started to create a team of volunteers to conduct mental health sessions from shelter to shelter. In this collaboration, her team has already provided services to over 250 children affected by displacement due to the war. She was able to get a little money in from international sources including support connected with the US parliament to get the logistics and materials started.

In terms of the impact she hopes to achieve, Ghina's vision is highly inspiring and exhibits sensitive leadership. Although she had received grants from abroad, she said she doesn't want it to be hers in the long run, as she wants them to become their own project. Now she wants to take her work to the next level by directly working with the Lebanese government. What her poster says loud and clear is, "The shelter was full, the policy table was empty." She wants to get from

shelter to policy tables and embed this framework in an ongoing Emergency Social Protection Mechanism.

I was impressed when I spoke to Ghina to see the impact a student led project can have when someone is truly responsible for their community. It was incredibly inspiring to see her go from campus learning to her actual involvement in the middle of a big crisis and helping the children . It showed me that we do not have to wait for big organizations or governments to take the first step. Change can start from below through our own skills and dedication. I have definitely been inspired to consider how I can apply what I have learned in my education to make a difference in the world in the future.